CLASS XII MUSIC

Hindustani Music – Melodic Instruments

Extremely Detailed Notes with Guitar-Friendly Explanations

CBSE academic session: 2026–27 | **Official subject code:** 035

Theory • Ragas • Talas • Instrument knowledge • Practical preparation • Diagrams • Revision questions

Important syllabus note
The official CBSE curriculum offers *Hindustani Music – Melodic Instruments*. It does not name Guitar as a separate Class XII subject or explicitly guarantee that every guitar type is accepted for practical assessment. This PDF follows the official Class XII melodic-instrument theory and practical topics, using guitar-friendly explanations where possible. Confirm with your school/CBSE music teacher that your chosen guitar is approved for your practical examination.

Official source: CBSE Academic, Hindustani Music – Melodic Instruments, Subject Code 035, Class XII (2026–27).

How to use these notes

• **Board theory:** Learn the definitions, historical themes, comparisons, tala structures, and biographies in the five units.

• **Practical:** Raga performance, gat, alap–jor–jhala, meend, tala recitation, raga recognition, and tuning require guided practice with a qualified teacher.

• **Guitar adaptation:** Western guitar frets do not automatically reproduce every nuance of Hindustani melodic instruments. Treat guitar examples as conceptual aids, not as an official CBSE guitar method.

• **Notation:** Swara examples below are illustrative. Your teacher's prescribed bandish/gat, raga grammar, and school notation should take priority.

Official Class XII assessment at a glance

Component	Marks	What it means
Theory	30	Two-hour paper; five units, 6 marks each as listed in the syllabus.
Practical	70	Performance and viva-style assessment; the syllabus gives a 15–20 minute time window per candidate.
Theory Unit 1	6	Gram, Murchhana, Alankar, Alap, Tana; Gamak, Meend, Kan, Krintan, Zamzama, Ghaseet, Sut.
Theory Unit 2	6	Historical development of the time theory of ragas.
Theory Unit 3	6	Sangeet Ratnakar, Sangeet Parijat; Inayat Khan, Mushtaq Ali Khan, Alauddin Khan.
Theory Unit 4	6	Jhaptala and Rupak; notation in Thah, Dugun, Tigun, Chaugun; tuning of chosen instrument.
Theory Unit 5	6	Raga study and notation: Bhairav, Bageshri, Malkauns.

The official Class XII practical topics include Razakhani gat in Bhairav, Bageshri and Malkauns; Masitkhani gat; alap, jor, jhala and meend; one composition in Ektala or Jhaptala; raga recognition; Jhaptala and Rupak recitation; instrument tuning; and a practical file.

Unit 1 — Musical concepts and ornamentation

1.1 Gram

Meaning: Gram is a theoretical arrangement/system of swaras used in early Indian music theory. Classical texts discuss systems such as Shadja-gram and Madhyama-gram. Gram is a historical concept; modern raga performance is not simply a scale played in any order.

Why it matters: It shows that Indian music theory developed systematic ways to organise pitch relationships. In an exam answer, define the term, name the principal historical grams, and explain its role in the evolution of swara organisation.

1.2 Murchhana

Meaning: Murchhana is a modal shift or a scale-like sequence formed by beginning from a different swara within a gram. It is an important historical bridge between older pitch systems and later ways of thinking about melodic frameworks.

Remember: Murchhana and raga are not synonyms. A raga includes characteristic phrases, important notes, ascent/descent, ornamentation, and rules of movement—not only a sequence of pitches.

1.3 Alankar

Meaning: Alankar means a patterned arrangement of swaras used to train voice or instrument, improve control, and develop musical fluency. Alankars may use ascending, descending, alternating, or grouped patterns.

Pattern type	Illustrative pattern in sargam	Practice goal
Straight	Sa Re Ga Ma | Pa Dha Ni Sa'	Even tone and pitch accuracy
Descending	Sa' Ni Dha Pa | Ma Ga Re Sa	Control while descending

Pattern type	Illustrative pattern in sargam	Practice goal
Grouped	Sa Re Ga, Re Ga Ma, Ga Ma Pa	Smooth shifts between groups
Alternating	Sa Ga Re Ma | Ga Pa Ma Dha	Coordination and note clarity

Use the sargam syllables Sa, Re, Ga, Ma, Pa, Dha, Ni. In a guitar exercise, play one note per fret only as a pitch-finding drill; the musical goal is clean intonation and phrasing, not mechanical speed.

1.4 Alap

Meaning: Alap is the unhurried melodic exploration of a raga, generally without a fixed rhythmic cycle at its opening. It introduces the raga's mood, important swaras, characteristic phrases, and melodic identity.

• Begin from a stable reference pitch (Sa) and establish the raga's sound world.

• Introduce notes gradually; do not rush through the entire scale.

• Use characteristic phrases (pakad/chalan) rather than treating the raga as a generic scale.

• Keep pauses, note duration, and melodic direction expressive and controlled.

1.5 Tana

Meaning: Tana is a fast melodic passage using swaras, usually developed from the grammar of the raga. Tanas may be straight, patterned, bol-like in vocal music, or rhythmically articulated in instrumental music.

Exam distinction: Alap generally explores the raga slowly and freely; tana is a faster, more compact melodic run. Speed alone does not make a passage musically correct: raga grammar must remain intact.

1.6 Gamak

Meaning: Gamak is a forceful, oscillating or emphatic ornament that gives a swara expressive movement. Its exact execution depends on the instrument, raga, and stylistic tradition.

Guitar note: A controlled bend or repeated-note movement may approximate some effects in limited contexts, but a normal fretted guitar cannot reproduce every classical gamak exactly. Avoid forcing strings or bending beyond safe technique.

1.7 Meend

Meaning: Meend is a smooth glide from one swara to another, passing through the pitch space between them rather than striking every intermediate note separately.

Guitar adaptation: A small, controlled slide between frets can illustrate a glide. Use a clean sound, listen carefully to the target pitch, and remember that the instrument's physical construction limits the shape and continuity of a meend.

1.8 Kan

Meaning: Kan is a grace note or a very brief touch of an adjacent swara that colours a main note. The grace note is not usually given the same weight or duration as the main swara.

1.9 Krintan

Meaning: Krintan is a plucking/striking ornament in instrumental music in which a note is articulated through a particular plucking or finger action. Terminology and exact execution can vary across instruments and lineages; learn the form demonstrated by your teacher.

1.10 Zamzama

Meaning: Zamzama is a quick, closely packed ornamental movement involving several swaras. It creates brilliance and intricacy while remaining within the raga's grammar.

1.11 Ghaseet

Meaning: Ghaseet is a dragging or sliding movement between notes associated with certain plucked-string instrumental styles. It is related to the idea of continuous pitch movement, but its specific technique differs by instrument.

1.12 Sut

Meaning: Sut is a traditional instrumental ornament/technique named in the syllabus. Descriptions may vary by instrument and teaching lineage, so use the definition and demonstration supplied by your teacher for the exact practical form.

Revision tip: For each ornament, write (1) definition, (2) how it changes the sound, (3) an instrument example, and (4) one difference from another ornament.

Unit 2 — Historical development of the time theory of ragas

2.1 What is raga time theory?

Raga time theory is the traditional view that particular ragas are most appropriate at certain hours of the day or night, and in some traditions at particular seasons. The idea connects musical mood, tonal emphasis, performance convention, and the listener's experience.

2.2 Why time is associated with ragas

• **Rasa and mood:** A raga's melodic character may be associated with calmness, devotion, pathos, brightness, or intensity.

• **Pitch relationships:** Traditional explanations often discuss the role and treatment of particular swaras, including komal and shuddha forms.

• **Performance tradition:** The time associations are maintained through teaching lineages, concert practice, and theoretical writing.

• **Seasonal associations:** Some ragas are traditionally linked with particular seasons or occasions.

2.3 Broad time divisions

Traditional category	Broad idea	Caution
Morning ragas	Traditionally associated with early daylight hours	Exact raga placement varies by tradition.
Afternoon ragas	Associated with the later daytime period	Do not assign every raga using a simple mood rule.
Evening ragas	Associated with dusk and early night	Performance conventions are learned from tradition.
Late-night ragas	Associated with later night hours	Different gharanas and modern concerts may vary.

2.4 Historical development — a useful answer structure

The time theory of ragas developed over a long period rather than being created by one single author. Older Indian music theory discussed swaras, scales, modal structures and melodic forms. Over time, raga identities and performance traditions became more detailed, and links between raga, mood and time were systematised in theoretical and pedagogical traditions.

• Early music treatises developed ideas about pitch, swara organisation and melodic forms.

• Medieval music literature elaborated raga descriptions and performance practice.

• Later scholars and musicologists classified and documented ragas in more organised systems.

• Modern musicians continue to teach time associations, while concert schedules and contemporary practice can sometimes differ from traditional ideals.

Model 5-mark response: Raga time theory is a traditional principle assigning certain ragas to particular periods of the day or night. Its purpose is to connect melodic character and performance convention with an appropriate time and mood. It developed gradually through musicological writing and oral teaching traditions. Raga time classifications are learned through tradition and may vary in detail; therefore, a raga should be identified by its swaras, characteristic phrases and grammar, not time alone.

2.5 What not to write

• Do not claim that every musician must perform a raga only at its traditional time in all modern contexts.

• Do not identify a raga only from a mood word such as 'sad' or 'happy'.

• Do not confuse raga time theory with tala, which is a rhythmic cycle.

Unit 3 — Treatises and musicians

3.1 Sangeet Ratnakar

Author: Sharngadeva (also spelled ■■r■gadeva). **Period:** commonly placed in the 13th century. **Importance:** Sangeet Ratnakar is a major Sanskrit musicological treatise that preserves and organises knowledge of Indian music from its period. It is significant for discussions of swara, raga, tala and performance-related subjects.

• It is often treated as an important source for understanding the development of Indian music theory.

• It reflects a historical stage before later distinctions between Hindustani and Carnatic traditions became fully established.

• It is useful to scholars because it records theoretical concepts, terminology and musical thinking from its era.

3.2 Sangeet Parijat

Author: Ahobala. **Period:** generally associated with the 17th century. **Importance:** Sangeet Parijat is an important later music treatise discussing swaras, musical theory and classification. It is studied to understand how Indian music theory continued to be interpreted and organised.

Comparison: Sangeet Ratnakar is an earlier foundational source; Sangeet Parijat reflects later theoretical developments. Both are important for the historical study of Indian music, but they belong to different periods and intellectual contexts.

Point	Sangeet Ratnakar	Sangeet Parijat
Author	Sharngadeva	Ahobala
Broad period	13th century	17th century
Study value	Major source for earlier music theory	Later account of swara and music theory
Exam method	Mention author, period, scope, importance	Mention author, period, scope, importance

3.3 Ustad Inayat Khan

Ustad Inayat Khan (1882–1938) was an influential sitar musician from a distinguished musical family and is associated with the development and transmission of sitar performance traditions. He also became known internationally for his Sufi teachings. For a music exam, focus on his place in the instrumental tradition and the importance of lineage, training and performance style.

3.4 Ustad Mushtaq Ali Khan

Ustad Mushtaq Ali Khan (1911–1989) was a respected sitar and surbahar player associated with the Senia tradition. He is remembered for maintaining an older instrumental style and for his commitment to traditional raga presentation. In answers, connect his contribution with preservation of repertoire, instrumental technique and stylistic continuity.

3.5 Baba Allauddin Khan

Baba Allauddin Khan (c. 1862–1972) was a major multi-instrumentalist, composer and teacher associated with Maihar. He trained several leading musicians and developed a rigorous approach to raga study, instrumental discipline and ensemble performance. His contribution is especially significant in the history of modern Hindustani instrumental music.

3.6 Biography answer framework

For each musician, learn: (1) full name and dates if required by your teacher, (2) instrument or musical role, (3) gharana/lineage or major association, (4) teaching or performance contribution, and (5) lasting influence. Avoid filling an answer with unrelated personal details.

Dates and biographical descriptions can be represented differently in reference books. Use the spelling and details prescribed by your teacher or textbook if they differ.

Unit 4 — Talas, notation and instrument tuning

4.1 Core tala vocabulary

Term	Meaning
Tala	A repeating rhythmic cycle organised into beats and sections.
Matra	One beat/unit within a tala cycle.
Vibhag	A section or grouping of matras within the cycle.
Sam	The first and structurally important beat of the cycle; the return point.
Tali	Clapped section marker.
Khali	Wave/empty-hand marker indicating a contrasting section.
Theka	Characteristic pattern of bols that expresses the tala.
Avartan	One complete cycle of the tala.
Laya	Tempo or speed of rhythmic movement.
Thah	Single/normal speed, one event per beat in a basic notation exercise.
Dugun	Double density/speed: two units for each beat.
Tigun	Triple density/speed: three units for each beat.
Chaugun	Fourfold density/speed: four units for each beat.

4.2 Jhaptala

Structure: 10 matras, grouped 2 + 3 + 2 + 3. A common clapping pattern is tali on matras 1, 3 and 8, with khali on matra 6. Theka bols may vary by tradition.

Matra	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Vibhag	1	1	2	2	2	3	3	4	4	4
Marker	Clap	—	Clap	—	—	Wave	—	Clap	—	—
Example theka	Dhi	Na	Dhi	Dhi	Na	Ti	Na	Dhi	Dhi	Na

Memory aid: count 2, then 3, then 2, then 3. Clap–clap–wave–clap is a useful basic marker sequence. Learn the exact theka taught in class.

4.3 Rupak tala

Structure: 7 matras, commonly grouped 3 + 2 + 2. A distinctive feature of the common Hindustani presentation is that the first section is khali (wave) and the later sections are clapped.

Matra	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
Vibhag	1	1	1	2	2	3	3
Marker	Wave	—	—	Clap	—	Clap	—
Example theka	Tin	Tin	Na	Dhin	Na	Dhin	Na

Because the first beat of Rupak is often khali, do not automatically use the same clap pattern as Jhaptala. The exact bol wording can differ among teaching sources.

4.4 Notation in Thah, Dugun, Tigun and Chaugun

The syllabus asks students to write tala notation in four layakaris. A reliable method is to keep the number of matras in the cycle fixed and increase the number of written rhythmic units fitted into each matra.

Laya	Units per matra	For a 10-matra cycle	For a 7-matra cycle
Thah	1	10 units	7 units
Dugun	2	20 units	14 units
Tigun	3	30 units	21 units
Chaugun	4	40 units	28 units

Practice method: First recite the theka at a steady pulse and mark the vibhags. Then say two evenly spaced syllables per pulse for dugun, three for tigun and four for chaugun. Do not speed up the underlying pulse accidentally; increase the subdivision density.

4.5 Ektala and Chautala — revision from the wider instrumental syllabus

Although Class XII theory specifically names Jhaptala and Rupak, Ektala and Chautala appear in the Class XII practical requirement and in the broader melodic-instrument course. Practise their thekas with your teacher.

Tala	Matras	Common grouping	Use in preparation
Ektala	12	6 sections of 2	Class XII practical: one composition may be presented in Ektala or Jhaptala.
Chautala	12	6 sections of 2	The wider melodic-instrument syllabus includes theka recitation and hand beats.
Teentala	16	4 sections of 4	Important in the Class XI foundation and instrumental practice.

4.6 Instrument tuning: guitar-friendly explanation

The official syllabus requires tuning of the chosen instrument. For a standard six-string steel-string or nylon-string guitar, the common modern tuning from the thickest string to the thinnest is E–A–D–G–B–E. This is a guitar convention, not a CBSE-mandated Hindustani tuning.

String	Open note (thick → thin)	Check
6	E2	Lowest standard string
5	A2	Perfect fourth above low E
4	D3	Perfect fourth above A
3	G3	Perfect fourth above D
2	B3	Major third above G
1	E4	Perfect fourth above B

Safe tuning routine: use a clip-on/electronic tuner or a reliable reference pitch; turn the tuning peg in small movements; pluck one string at a time; tune slowly; stop if a string feels unusually tight or damaged. Ask your teacher whether the practical requires a different tonic or tuning setup.

4.7 Simplified guitar diagram

Standard tuning	6	5	4	3	2	1
Open string	E	A	D	G	B	E
Example fret	0	0	0	0	0	0

A fret raises the pitch in semitone steps. Moving one fret higher raises a note by one semitone; moving 12 frets higher gives the octave. However, a raga is not simply a Western major/minor scale: its characteristic movements and ornamentation matter.

Unit 5 — Prescribed ragas: Bhairav, Bageshri and Malkauns

Raga details below are standard introductory descriptions. A raga's grammar is more nuanced than a scale chart, and gharanas may differ in some details. Learn the exact aroha, avaroha, pakad and composition prescribed by your school.

5.1 Raga Bhairav

Feature	Introductory description
Thaat (commonly taught)	Bhairav
Jati (commonly taught)	Sampurna–Sampurna (seven notes in ascent and descent)
Vadi–Samvadi (commonly taught)	Dha–Re
Main swara colour	Komal Re and komal Dha; remaining swaras generally shuddha
Traditional time	Early morning
Character	Serious, meditative, devotional
Illustrative aroha	Sa Re(komal) Ga Ma Pa Dha(komal) Ni Sa'
Illustrative avaroha	Sa' Ni Dha(komal) Pa Ma Ga Re(komal) Sa
Pakad / identity	Learn the exact phrase taught by your guru; phrases often emphasise the characteristic treatment of komal Re and Dha.

How to study Bhairav: Sing Sa and identify komal Re carefully. Practise slow transitions between Sa–komal Re–Ga and Pa–komal Dha–Ni without flattening the raga into a plain scale. Listen for the characteristic andolan (slow expressive oscillation) where taught.

5.2 Raga Bageshri (Bageshree)

Feature	Introductory description
Thaat (commonly taught)	Kafi
Jati (commonly taught)	Audav–Sampurna or a related treatment depending on the source and movement
Vadi–Samvadi (commonly taught)	Ma–Sa
Main swara colour	Komal Ga and komal Ni; Ma is prominent; Pa is often restricted or treated carefully in ascent
Traditional time	Late evening/night
Character	Intimate, contemplative, expressive
Illustrative aroha	Ni(komal) Sa Ga(komal) Ma Dha Ni(komal) Sa' (phrasing conventions vary)
Illustrative avaroha	Sa' Ni(komal) Dha Ma Pa Dha Ma Ga(komal) Re Sa (phrase-dependent)
Pakad / identity	Learn the taught chalan; prominence of Ma and characteristic movement around komal Ga/Ni are useful clues.

Important: Bageshri is especially easy to misrepresent as a scale. Its characteristic phrases, emphasis on Ma, and careful use of Pa matter. Follow your teacher's exact version.

5.3 Raga Malkauns

Feature	Introductory description
Thaat (commonly taught)	Often associated with Bhairavi in modern classification; historic/classificatory accounts vary
Jati	Audav–Audav (five notes in ascent and descent)
Vadi–Samvadi (commonly taught)	Ma–Sa
Notes used	Sa, komal Ga, shuddha Ma, komal Dha, komal Ni; Re and Pa are omitted

Feature	Introductory description
Traditional time	Late night
Character	Grave, meditative, introspective
Illustrative aroha	Sa Ga(komal) Ma Dha(komal) Ni(komal) Sa'
Illustrative avaroha	Sa' Ni(komal) Dha(komal) Ma Ga(komal) Sa
Key identity	Five-note structure; Re and Pa are omitted.

Memory aid: Malkauns has five notes: Sa, komal Ga, Ma, komal Dha, komal Ni. Re and Pa are not used in the basic raga structure. Practise the five-note contour slowly and preserve the raga's calm, weighty character.

5.4 Compare the three ragas

Feature	Bhairav	Bageshri	Malkauns
Basic note identity	Komal Re, komal Dha	Komal Ga, komal Ni; Ma prominent	Komal Ga, komal Dha, komal Ni; no Re/Pa
Common time	Morning	Late evening/night	Late night
Basic jati	Sampurna–Sampurna	Often described as audav–sampurna, with phrase nuances	Audav–Audav
Recognition clue	Distinctive treatment of komal Re and Dha	Ma-centred phrases and careful Pa usage	Five-note structure; Re and Pa omitted

5.5 How to recognise a raga from a swara phrase

• Listen for the notes that are present and absent. Malkauns is strongly suggested by the five-note set omitting Re and Pa.

• Notice komal and shuddha swaras. Bhairav's komal Re and komal Dha are important clues.

• Listen to the movement, not only the pitch inventory. Bageshri's phrasing and emphasis cannot be captured by a scale list alone.

• Identify the phrase's landing notes and pauses. Vadi, samvadi and nyas swaras can help when taught.

• Do not guess solely from the raga's time or mood. Confirm with its chalan/pakad and characteristic treatment.

5.6 Notation and composition writing

The syllabus asks for notation of compositions in Bhairav, Bageshri and Malkauns. The exact prescribed compositions may be school- or teacher-specific; this guide does not invent an official bandish/gat. Use your class composition and record:

• Raga name and tonic (Sa) used.

• Tala name, matras, vibhag divisions, sam, tali and khali.

• Sthayi and antara (where the composition has these sections), clearly labelled.

• Swaras with octave marks according to the notation system your teacher uses.

• Tala marks and the exact point where the composition meets sam.

• Any prescribed gat, toda, tan or jhala material separately, with clear headings.

Blank practice template

Composition details	Fill in from your teacher's prescribed version
Raga	_____
Tala and total matras	_____

Composition details	Fill in from your teacher's prescribed version
Tonic / Sa	_____
Sthayi / main section	_____
Antara / second section	_____
Sam point and vibhag marks	_____
Ornamentation / elaboration	_____

Practical preparation — aligned to the official syllabus

1. Alap, jor, jhala and meend

Element	What it demonstrates	Practice checklist
Alap	Slow exploration of raga identity	Stable Sa; clear swaras; characteristic phrases; controlled pauses.
Jor	A more pulse-driven development after alap	Steady internal pulse; coherent phrases; no loss of raga identity.
Jhala	Energetic rhythmic development, often with rapid alternation of main and drone strings in traditional plucked instruments	Keep pulse controlled; avoid speed that damages clarity; adapt only if your teacher approves guitar technique.
Meend	Smooth pitch movement between notes	Target pitch accuracy; controlled movement; clean beginning and ending.

The syllabus names alap, jor and jhala because they are central to instrumental raga presentation. A standard guitar does not have the same sympathetic strings, fret layout or pitch-bending response as sitar/sarod. Demonstrate the musical idea within the technique your teacher has approved.

2. Masitkhani gat and Razakhani gat

Gat: A composed instrumental theme in a raga, commonly set to a tala. A gat provides a structured starting point for elaboration.

Masitkhani gat: Traditionally a slower, expansive gat associated with a dignified presentation. It often allows measured elaboration and careful development.

Razakhani gat: Traditionally a faster, more lively gat, often supporting taans/todas and jhala-like development.

Point	Masitkhani gat	Razakhani gat
General character	Slow, spacious, dignified	Faster, lively, energetic
Learning focus	Clarity of composition, raga development, measured elaboration	Rhythmic precision, taans/todas, clean transitions
Exam preparation	Learn one prescribed gat and a few appropriate taans	Learn one prescribed gat, elaborations, todas and jhala as taught

3. Tuning and instrument viva

Prepare to explain the parts of the instrument accepted for your assessment. For a guitar, possible parts include headstock, tuning pegs, nut, neck, fretboard, frets, strings, body, sound hole (acoustic guitar), bridge, saddle and pickguard (if present). Be prepared to state your tuning and demonstrate how you check pitch.

Guitar part	Function
Headstock + tuning pegs	Hold and adjust string tension to change pitch.
Nut	Supports strings at the headstock end and sets their spacing.
Neck + fretboard	Supports the frets and provides the playing surface.
Frets	Divide the string length into semitone positions.
Body / sound hole	On an acoustic guitar, the body helps amplify string vibration.
Bridge + saddle	Anchor/support the strings at the body end.
Strings	Vibrate to produce sound; thickness and tension affect feel and pitch.

4. Raga recognition drill

• Round 1: listen and sing Sa; identify each swara as shuddha or komal.

• Round 2: write the likely note set and mark any missing swaras.

• Round 3: sing or play the phrase slowly; compare it with the raga's taught pakad/chalan.

• Round 4: state one or two reasons for your identification rather than only naming the raga.

• Round 5: repeat after a short pause so recognition is not based on memorising only one phrase.

5. Tala recitation drill

• Say the tala name and total matras before beginning.

• Mark each vibhag with the correct clap or wave.

• Recite the theka while keeping the hand pattern steady.

• Repeat in thah, then dugun and chaugun; for theory, also practise tigun for Jhaptala and Rupak.

• Finish exactly on sam and be able to explain where sam occurs.

6. Practical file checklist

• Cover page, student details and subject information as directed by school.

• Contents page and clearly labelled sections.

• Short notes on prescribed ragas: aroha, avaroha, jati, vadi, samvadi, time, pakad and swara features, as taught.

• Tala charts with matras, vibhag, tali/khali, theka and layakari.

• Prescribed composition notation, copied accurately from the teacher's version.

• Instrument diagram and tuning notes, if permitted/required by the teacher.

• Dates or teacher comments if the school asks for them.

High-yield revision sheets

One-line definitions

Term	One-line revision
Gram	An early theoretical system for organising swaras.
Murchhana	A modal/scale-like sequence beginning from a different swara within a system.
Alankar	A patterned swara exercise for training and fluency.
Alap	Unhurried melodic exploration of a raga.
Tana	A fast melodic passage developed from raga swaras.
Gamak	An expressive oscillating or emphatic ornament.
Meend	A smooth glide between pitches.
Kan	A brief grace-note touch of an adjacent swara.
Krintan	A traditional instrumental plucking/striking ornament.
Zamzama	A quick, closely packed ornamental movement of swaras.
Ghaseet	A dragging/sliding movement between notes in instrumental styles.
Sut	A traditional instrumental ornament/technique; learn the teacher's exact form.
Raga time theory	Traditional association of ragas with particular times or seasons.
Tala	A repeating rhythmic cycle.
Theka	The characteristic bol pattern expressing a tala.
Sam	The first and structurally important beat of a tala cycle.

Possible short-answer questions

• Define gram and murchhana. How are they different from a raga?

• What is an alankar? Give two examples of patterned swara exercises.

• Differentiate alap and tana.

• Explain meend, kan and gamak with one instrument-related example each.

• What is raga time theory? Briefly describe its historical development.

• Write short notes on Sangeet Ratnakar and Sangeet Parijat.

• Describe the contributions of Inayat Khan, Mushtaq Ali Khan and Allauddin Khan.

• Describe Jhaptala and Rupak with their matras and vibhag structure.

• Explain thah, dugun, tigun and chaugun.

• Describe the basic swara features of Bhairav, Bageshri and Malkauns.

• How would you recognise Malkauns from a short swara phrase?

• Describe the parts and tuning of your chosen instrument.

Possible long-answer questions

• Explain the main concepts and ornaments listed in Unit 1 with definitions and examples.

• Discuss the historical development and purpose of raga time theory.

• Compare Sangeet Ratnakar and Sangeet Parijat, including their historical importance.

• Describe Jhaptala and Rupak, and explain how their notation changes in thah, dugun, tigun and chaugun.

• Give a comparative study of Bhairav, Bageshri and Malkauns using their swara features and characteristic movements.

• Describe the practical steps involved in presenting a raga through alap, jor, gat, taans/todas and jhala.

Last-minute study plan

Session	Task
1	Definitions: gram, murchhana, alankar, alap, tana, ornaments.
2	Raga time theory; write one model 5-mark answer.
3	Sangeet Ratnakar, Sangeet Parijat and three musician biographies.
4	Jhaptala and Rupak structures; practise hand beats and layakari.
5	Bhairav, Bageshri, Malkauns: note features, compare and identify.
6	Practical: tuning, instrument viva, alap/jor/jhala and prescribed gat with teacher.
7	Revise all definitions and answer practice questions without looking.

Official syllabus coverage and limitations

This PDF follows the five theory units and the practical topics stated in CBSE's official 2026–27 Class XII Hindustani Music – Melodic Instruments syllabus, Subject Code 035. It is a study aid, not a replacement for the official syllabus, prescribed textbook, school notes or teacher's composition notation.

The syllabus specifically names Bhairav, Bageshri and Malkauns for Class XII raga study; Jhaptala and Rupak for theory tala notation; and practical requirements including Masitkhani/Razakhani gats, alap–jor–jhala, meend, a composition in Ektala or Jhaptala, raga recognition, tala recitation and instrument tuning.

Because guitar is not explicitly named as a separate CBSE subject in this document, obtain confirmation from your school before relying on guitar-specific techniques for practical marks.

Official CBSE PDF: https://cbseacademic.nic.in/web_material/CurriculumMain27/SecPart2/Hindustani_Melodic_SecP2_2026-27.pdf